

Learnify AI — Product Strategy & Feature Validation

Prepared as a working strategy document, not a guarantee of outcomes. Revenue and growth figures below are directional planning estimates based on common EdTech/SaaS benchmarks — not projections I can verify against your actual usage data. Treat them as scenarios to stress-test, not commitments.

0. What I actually verified vs. what I'm inferring

I fetched the live site before writing this. Here's what that confirmed:

- **The homepage is stronger than the audit prompt assumes.** You already have a live, no-signup interactive demo ("See it in action" — AI Tutor chat, quiz generator, flashcards) and a real value-prop hierarchy (six pillars: AI Tutor, Smart Notes, Gamified Progress, Creator Economy, Wallet, Career Intelligence). The "Watch Demo / Platform Demo" item in your missing-features list is **already built** — don't rebuild it, just instrument it (track demo → signup conversion).
- **Footer/nav confirms real IA:** Features, AI Tools, Pricing, Roadmap, Blog, Community, Events, About, Careers, Contact, FAQ, Privacy, Terms, Refund Policy, `/apply-creator`, `/cohorts` all resolve as routes.
- **What's conspicuously absent from primary nav:** no Documentation/Help Center link, no Certificate Verification link, no Coach application link (only "Apply to Creator Program" — the coach path isn't surfaced anywhere on the homepage), no mobile app page. This matches your own "missing features" list — I can confirm these are genuinely not linked publicly, at least.
- Pricing, Roadmap, and dashboard pages are client-rendered (React SPA behind auth for most of it), so I can't see actual plan copy, admin panel internals, real revenue, or DB structure — those come from what you and your memory of prior audits have already told me. I'm not going to invent numbers for things I can't see.

Given that, this document focuses on the **strategy/validation prompt** (Keep/Improve/Remove/Merge/Future + Cart/Wallet/Payment/Pricing/Ecosystem analysis) rather than re-running a line-by-line UI audit I can't fully see. If you want the full UI/mobile/SEO audit from your second prompt, that needs either screen recordings, exported HTML/DOM, or you giving me authenticated access — happy to do it once I can actually see those screens.

1. Your own recommendations — validated

Your pre-audit recommendations at the bottom of your message are, structurally, the right instincts. I'd sign off on all of them with light refinements:

Your call	Verdict	Refinement
Keep Cart, only for paid courses/creator products/marketplace	Agree	Also route certificate upsells and credit packs through Cart if bought alongside a course; keep subscriptions and solo credit-pack top-ups on direct checkout
No Cart for subscriptions	Agree, strongly	Every extra step in a subscription flow costs conversion. Direct checkout only.
Wallet for Creator/Coach earnings, referral, cashback, affiliate	Agree	Add one more use: AI credit refunds/goodwill credits — cheaper to issue than cash refunds and keeps the money in-platform
Wallet not for normal students	Agree, with one exception	Give students a wallet automatically the moment they earn <i>anything</i> (referral bonus, challenge prize) — don't make them "apply" for a wallet. Otherwise their first-earned-rupee experience is a dead end.
Free/Paid/Subscription/Creator-commission course model	Agree	This is the correct four-quadrant model — see §3
Three revenue streams (subscriptions + course sales + marketplace commission)	Agree, add a fourth	AI credit overage/top-ups is a real, high-margin fourth stream once you have paying power-users — see §12

Nothing here needs pushback. The bigger risk to your plan isn't the model — it's **sequencing** (building Coach ecosystem, Community, and Marketplace simultaneously before Courses+AI Tools+Certificates are converting well). See §7, §8, and the roadmap in §14.

2. Feature Validation Matrix

Legend: Keep · Improve · Remove · Merge · Future

Public Website

Feature	Verdict	Why
Features / AI Tools / Pricing / Blog	K	Standard, working IA
Creators / Coaches pages	I	Split these — creators and coaches have different economics (commission vs. booking fee). Don't template one page for both.
Roadmap (public)	K	Genuinely good trust signal, keep public
Interactive demo (AI Tutor, quiz gen)	I	Already built — add a "generate my first note/flashcard" CTA that hands off directly into signup with the generated content preserved, so the demo isn't a dead end
Documentation Hub	F	Build once you have >3 support tickets/week asking "how do I..." — don't pre-build
Certificate Verification Portal	Must Have, not Future	This is trust infrastructure for your certificates to mean anything to employers — see §13

Student Dashboard

Feature	Verdict	Why
Dashboard, Courses, Certificates, AI Chat	K	Core loop
Community, Leaderboard, Achievements, Challenges, Inbox	M	Merge into a single "Community" tab with sub-tabs (Feed / Leaderboard / Challenges). Five separate nav items for social features is nav bloat for a pre-PMF product.
Cart	K (scoped)	Per §1
Wallet	I	Only show to students once they've earned something; otherwise hide from nav to reduce clutter
Resume Builder, ATS Checker, Interview Prep,	M	These are five entry points into one job: "get hired." Merge into a single "Career Studio" with the five as

Feature	Verdict	Why
Career Roadmap, Portfolio Builder		steps/tabs inside it, not five sidebar items. This is your highest-perceived-value cluster — don't fragment it.
Billing, Settings, Profile, Notifications, Security	M	Standard "Account" mega-section with sub-tabs, one nav item
Submissions	I	Only keep as separate nav if it's coach/cohort assignment submissions; otherwise fold into Courses

Admin Panel

Feature	Verdict	Why
Command Center (revenue, AI cost, payouts, forecasting)	K	This is your most valuable internal tool — invest here before investing in more student-facing features
Content Manager (14+ sub-items: events, jobs, pricing, certs, FAQs, pages, coupons, groups, blog, WCMS, media, features catalog, menus, sections)	I	Right now this is a CMS trying to be a headless CMS. Long-term, consider a real headless CMS (Sanity — you already have it connected) for Blog/FAQ/Pages/Media instead of hand-rolling admin screens for each
Users, Subscriptions, Billing OS	K	Core ops
Creator Studio (admin side)	K	Needed for verification/approval workflow

3. Courses Strategy

Free courses — yes, keep small (3–5 genuinely complete, not teasers). Purpose is lead-gen and AI-Tutor-usage-gen, not revenue. Expected effect: lowers signup friction, raises trial-to-paid conversion because people experience course completion + AI tools together before paying. Don't gate AI Tutor behind payment for the free course — that combination is your differentiator vs. plain Udemy-style free courses.

Paid courses — one-time purchase, sold through Cart. This is your "impulse buy" revenue lane, separate from subscription commitment. Don't force paid courses behind a subscription; that removes an entire conversion path (people who'll pay ₹999 once but won't commit to ₹499/month).

Creator courses + commission — 20-30% is reasonable and matches Teachable/Podia-range platforms; I'd start at 25% flat with no tiers (tiered commission structures are a common creator complaint — "why does my rate change" creates support burden for marginal revenue gain). Revisit at scale, not at launch.

Certificates — three-tier model:

- Free completion certificate (basic, watermarked "Learnify AI" style, no verification page) — retention/shareability tool
- Paid "Verified Certificate" (₹199-₹499, includes public verification URL + QR code + LinkedIn "Add to Profile" button) — this is a real, proven revenue lane (Coursera's entire early model)
- Premium/Creator-issued certificates — creator sets price, Learnify takes the same 25% commission as courses

Net course-related revenue lanes: 3 (paid courses, verified certificates, creator commission) **stacked on top of subscriptions.**

4. Cart — final recommendation

Keep it, scoped exactly as you proposed: paid courses, creator digital products, certificate upgrades, credit packs bought *alongside* something else. Subscriptions and standalone credit top-ups bypass Cart entirely and go straight to checkout. This isn't really a debate — it's the correct default for any platform mixing one-time and recurring purchases (Notion, Figma, and Canva all do exactly this split).

5. Wallet — final recommendation

Keep it, scoped to earners (Creators, Coaches, referral/affiliate earners, contest winners) plus reactive student credit (refunds/goodwill). Don't build a general-purpose student wallet UI (top-up, balance-as-payment-method) — that's a payments feature disguised as a wallet feature and it multiplies your compliance surface (prepaid instrument regulations in India apply differently once students can *load* money in versus only *receive* it). **This is a genuine legal distinction, not just a UX one** — a wallet that only receives platform-earned payouts is simpler to operate under Indian PPI rules than one where users deposit their own money. Worth a real conversation with a payments/legal advisor before letting students top up wallets directly, since I'm not able to give you a compliance sign-off here.

6. Payment Architecture (Cashfree)

One flag first: your prior technical work referenced Stripe (with an INR currency fix), and this prompt lists Cashfree as the current gateway. If both are still wired in anywhere, consolidate — running two payment providers in parallel is a common source of the exact race-condition and webhook-security bugs your own audit prompt asks about. Pick one as canonical (Cashfree makes sense for India-first: better UPI/netbanking coverage, GST-friendly invoicing, lower blended fees than Stripe for INR).

Recommended architecture:

- **Subscriptions:** Cashfree Subscriptions API (recurring mandate), webhook-driven state changes only — never trust the client redirect as source of truth for "payment succeeded"
- **Course/certificate purchases:** Cashfree Orders API, one order per Cart checkout, idempotency key = cart session ID to prevent duplicate charges on retry
- **Wallet topups (creator/coach side, e.g., minimum payout threshold pre-funding if you ever need it):** separate ledger table, every wallet mutation is an **atomic** DB transaction (insert into `wallet_transactions` + update `wallet_balance` in one transaction, not read-modify-write — this is exactly the race condition already flagged in your architecture)
- **Payouts:** Cashfree Payouts API, batched (weekly/bi-weekly, not instant) with a minimum threshold (₹500-1000) to keep payout fees from eating small creator earnings
- **Refunds:** policy-driven, auto-approve within a window (e.g., 7 days + <20% course completion), manual review outside it
- **GST:** every invoice needs GSTIN capture (optional for B2C, required for B2B/Enterprise), and Cashfree's invoicing should be the single source of truth — don't hand-generate invoice PDFs separately, it's a reconciliation nightmare later

7. Pricing Strategy

Your proposed numbers are close to right for the Indian EdTech market. Refined ladder:

Plan	Price	Who it's for	Includes
Free	₹0	Everyone	1–3 free courses, limited AI credits/day, community access
Pro	₹199/mo	Casual learners	Full course library, higher AI credit cap, notes/flashcard generation
Career Pro	₹499/mo	Job-seekers	Everything in Pro + Resume/ATS/Interview Prep/Career Roadmap suite, verified certificates included
Enterprise	Custom	Colleges/companies	Seats, SSO, admin reporting, custom branding

Change from your draft: don't sell "Creator Pro" and "Coach Pro" as subscription tiers on the same pricing page as student plans. Creators/coaches aren't buying access to content — they're buying selling tools. Two options instead:

1. Free to become a creator/coach (commission-only, 25–30%), with an **optional** "Creator Pro" add-on (₹999/mo) that *lowers* commission to ~15% and unlocks advanced analytics — this is the Etsy/Teachable pattern and it converts better because there's no upfront risk for a new creator
2. Keep it purely commission-based at launch and introduce the Pro add-on only once you have enough creators to know your unit economics

I'd start with option 2. Simpler to explain, no pricing page confusion between "what I pay to learn" and "what I pay to sell."

8. Creator Ecosystem — Phasing

- **Phase 1 (now):** Apply-to-join, course creation, 25% flat commission, basic earnings dashboard, payout via Wallet
- **Phase 2 (after ~20-50 active creators):** Creator analytics (views, completion, revenue trends), creator verification badge, public creator profile pages
- **Phase 3 (after real marketplace volume):** Creator ranking/leaderboard, Creator Pro subscription tier with reduced commission, creator-run cohorts/live sessions

Don't build ranking or a full marketplace discovery page before you have enough creators that discovery is actually a problem — an empty "Browse Creators" page hurts trust more than not having the page.

9. Coach Ecosystem — Phasing

- **Phase 1:** Apply-to-join (build this — it's currently missing from your nav), simple booking (Calendly-style external embed is fine initially, don't build your own scheduling engine yet), manual/semi-manual payment collection through your existing Cashfree checkout
- **Phase 2:** In-platform calendar, native video sessions (or Zoom/Meet integration — don't build WebRTC infra yourself this early), ratings/reviews
- **Phase 3:** Coach marketplace discovery, coach analytics, Coach Pro tier

Coaching is a heavier lift than creator courses (live time commitment, scheduling reliability, refund disputes are messier). I'd deliberately keep this **behind** the Creator ecosystem in priority — validate the async/course marketplace first.

10. AI Tools — Tier Mapping

Tool	Free	Pro	Career Pro
AI Chat / Tutor	Limited daily credits	Higher cap	Higher cap
Quiz Generator, Smart Notes/Flashcards	Limited	Full	Full
Resume Builder, ATS Checker, Interview Prep, Career Roadmap	Preview only (1 use)	—	Full
Portfolio Builder	—	—	Full

Career-outcome tools are your best paid-conversion lever — gate them behind Career Pro specifically rather than spreading them across Free/Pro, so there's one clear "I need a job, I need Career Pro" moment.

11. Community & Gamification

- **Keep:** Community feed, Leaderboard (drives daily-active habit loops cheaply)
- **Merge:** Achievements + Challenges + Leaderboard into one "Progress" tab (per §2)
- **Remove nothing outright**, but don't invest further design/engineering time here until Courses + AI Tools + Certificates are converting well — gamification amplifies retention of an already-good core product, it doesn't fix a weak one.

12. Revenue Strategy

Realistic stacked model once live (order of maturity, not necessarily order of size):

1. **Subscriptions** (Pro/Career Pro) — predictable base
2. **Paid courses** — impulse-purchase lane, higher AOV
3. **Creator/coach commission** — scales with ecosystem, not your effort
4. **Verified certificates** — near-zero marginal cost, pure margin
5. **AI credit top-ups/overage** — your power users will hit caps; sell credit packs (₹99/₹299/₹499) rather than forcing an upgrade — cheaper conversion than a full plan upsell
6. **Enterprise/institutional seats** — highest ACV, slowest sales cycle, don't prioritize until 1-5 are stable

Don't add ads or third-party affiliate placements — they undercut the "premium AI learning OS" positioning your homepage is already selling, and the revenue per user from ads is typically far below what one converted Career Pro subscriber is worth.

13. Missing Features — Prioritized

Must Have (build next, ranked):

1. Certificate Verification Portal (public URL + QR) — trust infrastructure, cheap to build, directly monetizable
2. Coach application/apply flow (currently invisible on the public site)
3. Career Studio merge (Resume/ATS/Interview/Roadmap/Portfolio into one flow) — UX fix, not new feature

Should Have: 4. Referral program (cheap CAC lever, plugs into Wallet you're already building) 5. Skill Gap Analysis (natural AI-tutor extension, strong upsell into Career Pro) 6. Basic Documentation/Help Center (once support volume justifies it)

Nice to Have: 7. Job Match Score, Salary Insights, LinkedIn Optimizer — real value, but require external data (job postings, salary datasets) you don't have yet; revisit once core AI tools are proven

Future: 8. Mobile app (Android/iOS) 9. Recruiter dashboard / job board 10. Freelance marketplace

14. Final Deliverable

Keep: Courses, Certificates, AI Tutor, Resume/ATS/Interview/Career-Roadmap suite

(merged as Career Studio), Community, Creator Studio, Cashfree payments, scoped Cart, scoped Wallet

Remove/simplify (nav-level, not feature-level): Separate sidebar items for Leaderboard/Achievements/Challenges/Inbox → merge into Community; separate Resume Builder/ATS/Interview/Roadmap/Portfolio → merge into Career Studio; separate Billing/Settings/Profile/Notifications/Security → merge into Account

Merge: See §2 and above

Build next: Certificate Verification Portal, Coach apply flow, Referral program

Delay: Coach live-session infra, marketplace discovery/ranking pages, mobile app, job board, recruiter dashboard, ads/affiliate revenue

30-Day Action Plan

- **Week 1:** Ship Certificate Verification Portal (public URL + QR); fix any remaining payment-provider consolidation (Cashfree vs. Stripe)
- **Week 2:** Merge Career tools into single "Career Studio" flow; add Coach apply page/form
- **Week 3:** Referral program (Wallet-based payout, since Wallet infra already exists)
- **Week 4:** Merge Community/Achievements/Challenges nav; instrument the homepage demo → signup funnel

90-Day Roadmap

- **Month 1:** Above
- **Month 2:** Creator Phase 2 (analytics, verification badge, profile pages); AI credit top-up packs live
- **Month 3:** Coach Phase 1 live (apply + basic booking, external calendar embed); pricing page A/B test (your ladder vs. a simplified 3-tier version)

Expected Impact (directional, not guaranteed)

- Nav simplification (5→2 merges) typically improves dashboard engagement/retention in early-stage SaaS because it reduces decision fatigue — magnitude depends on your current usage data, which I don't have visibility into
- Certificate verification is close to pure-margin revenue once built — the ceiling is a function of how many students value LinkedIn-shareable proof, which you can measure directly once it ships
- Referral programs commonly reduce blended CAC when paired with an existing wallet/payout rail, since you avoid building new payment infrastructure for it

I'd treat all three as hypotheses to validate with your own analytics once shipped, not numbers to plan revenue around in advance.